

HackRice 16 — Judges

Contact sheet & LinkedIn reference

Rice Memorial Center, Houston, TX | Sep 11–13, 2026 | Devpost: <https://hackrice-16.devpost.com/>

32 judges are listed on Devpost. LinkedIn profiles are filled in where confirmed; blank rows are still to be identified. The Devpost listing gives names only — no company or title — so confirm identity before reaching out.

Judges (Devpost listing)

#	Name	LinkedIn
1	Michael Schwartz	— not yet identified —
2	Manoj Potnuru	— not yet identified —
3	Nicolae Sapoval	linkedin.com/in/nsapoval <i>matched via Rice CS</i>
4	Divyanshu Joshi	— not yet identified —
5	Stella Peng	linkedin.com/in/yiyun-stella-peng
6	Nicole Nobili	— not yet identified —
7	Neeharika Sompalli	linkedin.com/in/neecharikasompalli
8	Ganesh Harke	— not yet identified —
9	Rahul Chawla	— not yet identified —
10	Puneet Thakkar	— not yet identified —
11	Viraj Sabhaya	— not yet identified —
12	Jay Suresh Nirmal	— not yet identified —
13	Parsa Mazaheri	— not yet identified —
14	Elankumaran Srinivasan	— not yet identified —
15	Lovish Masand	— not yet identified —
16	Pratik Ghawate	— not yet identified —
17	Yi Sien Ku	— not yet identified —
18	Vincent Vu	— not yet identified —
19	Sachin Gurjar	— not yet identified —
20	Konstantinos Gkatzonis	— not yet identified —
21	Soumya Karnala	— not yet identified —
22	Sri Ram Swaminathan	— not yet identified —
23	Netan Mangal	— not yet identified —
24	Sai Nagabhairava	— not yet identified —

#	Name	LinkedIn
25	Sai Kishan Naraparaju	— not yet identified —
26	Taekhwan Oh	— not yet identified —
27	Nikolai Sidiropulo	— not yet identified —
28	Arnav Jha	— not yet identified —
29	Akshay Khataavkar	linkedin.com/in/akshay-khataavkar-006b2b5a
30	Vikas Gangadhara	— not yet identified —
31	Manjunath Shivarudrappa	— not yet identified —
32	Anuj Ashok Potdar	— not yet identified —

Additional contacts (not on the judge list)

These profiles were supplied but do not match any name in the Devpost judges section. They may be mentors, sponsor reps, or organizers.

Name	LinkedIn
Abhik Sengupta	linkedin.com/in/abhik-sengupta-a4417951
Ragul Balaji	linkedin.com/in/ragulbalaji
Navneet Tyagi	linkedin.com/in/navneet-tyagi-08812716

Filling in the blanks

- Search from inside LinkedIn rather than Google — it surfaces profiles public search engines miss.
- Add a company filter. HackRice judges are usually sponsor employees, so the sponsor list narrows common names fast.
- Judge badges at the event and the opening ceremony slides both show company affiliations.
- Email hack@rice.edu — organizers hold the judge roster with affiliations.

Judge names sourced from <https://hackrice-16.devpost.com/> (Rice University, HackRice 16). LinkedIn URLs are public professional profiles. Verify each match before contacting anyone.